"Unconditional love, equality best way to achieve bliss"

By **HAJI SYED SALMAN CHISHTY**

Growing up in Ajmer Dargah Sharif, an incredible 800-year-old historical neighbourhood, one got to witness people from all parts of India coming to seek blessings, people of varied faiths and religious backgrounds, who spoke different languages and had different traditions and cultural practices. Serving all those who come to the Dargah Ajmer Sharif brings us the greatest happiness. The spiritual elders of the Khuddam-e-Khwaja Sufi community have always taught us never to ask the name, religion, faith or the native land of anyone who comes to the dargah. If one had to ask a question, it is how can we serve these seekers who flock to the Ajmer Dargah Darbar Sharif?

One of the most profound teachings of Khwaja Gharib Nawaz Moinuddin Hasan Chishty is that true happiness is in seeking closeness to the Divine Creator. To achieve that, one should dedicate oneself to service with unconditional love, compassion and equality, exemplified by attributes of Nature itself, as learning to being gracious like the Sun, generous like the river and hospitable like the Earth.



DEEPAK SHARMA

HAPPINESS MANTRA

"Take the first step. God will ensure that you have the power to continue"

The ultimate purpose is the evolution of our spiritual being. By dedicating ourselves to our creator, we align ourselves with this purpose. The ups and downs of life will not seem so urgent then as we realise that the material world is ephemeral. What matters is the alignment of our intentions and actions with our goal of spiritual mastery.

Change won't come in a day, nor will it come easy. But if you start now by making the smallest commitment to leading a better, happier life, the road will be less rocky.

God says in the Hadith Qudsi: "Take one step towards me, I will take 10 towards you. Walk towards me, I will run towards you." Take the first step! God will be with you, making sure you have the power to continue. Inshallah. ■

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